THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which critical comment is valid? 1

(a) The poem links psychological growth with loss
(b) The poem is a satire
(c) The poem is about politics
(d) The poem is about trade

2. The ending leaves the boy's future: 1

(a) open and uncertain but hopeful **(b)** funny
(c) forgotten **(d)** closed and tragic

3. A feature of the poem's style is: 1

(a) colloquial yet reflective diction **(b)** archaic language
(c) slang **(d)** technical terms

4. The poem might be read by psychologists as a case of: 1

(a) a legal dispute **(b)** a travel diary
(c) early experience of loss and resilience **(d)** a game theory

5. An alternative title that fits the poem is: 1

(a) A Lesson in Loss **(b)** The Rich Boy
(c) The Harbour Game **(d)** A Harbour Holiday

6. The poem implies that society often: 1

(a) explains it **(b)** honours it
(c) trivialises children's grief **(d)** celebrates it

7. The phrase 'what, what is he to do' indicates: 1

(a) a joke **(b)** a quiz
(c) a command **(d)** the poet's anxious empathy

8. The poet's use of the word 'merrily' is: 1

(a) ironic in hindsight **(b)** literal only
(c) comic **(d)** sarcastic

9. The ball's trajectory 'merrily over' prepares for: 1

(a) a game **(b)** irreversible loss
(c) a gift **(d)** a rescue

10. Choose the sentence with inversion for emphasis. 1

(a) Grief the boy felt never.
(b) The boy had never felt such grief.
(c) The boy felt grief never before.
(d) Never before had the boy felt such grief.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How does the poem avoid moralising while teaching? 2

12. Discuss the relationship between the observer and the boy. 2

13. Why is the poem still relevant in a consumer society? 2

14. Compare the child's and adult's perspectives on loss in the poem. 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Evaluate the poem as a critique of consumerism. 3

16. Rewrite the idea 'money cannot replace grief' in three different ways. 3

17. How might the poem be adapted into a short film? 3

OR

How does the poem use contrast between public and private spaces? 3

18. Convert into direct speech: The poet told the boy that he would learn to stand up. 3

OR

Suggest a title for a prose essay on the poem. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Write an essay on 'Consumerism and the loss of emotional value' using the poem. 5

OR

Explain how the poem fits into the tradition of reflective lyric poetry. 5

20. Write a speech for a counselling workshop based on the poem. 5

OR

Write a dialogue between two teachers discussing how to teach this poem. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND